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(54) **SOURCE ELECTRODE AND DRAIN  
ELECTRODE PROTECTION FOR  
NANOWIRE TRANSISTORS**

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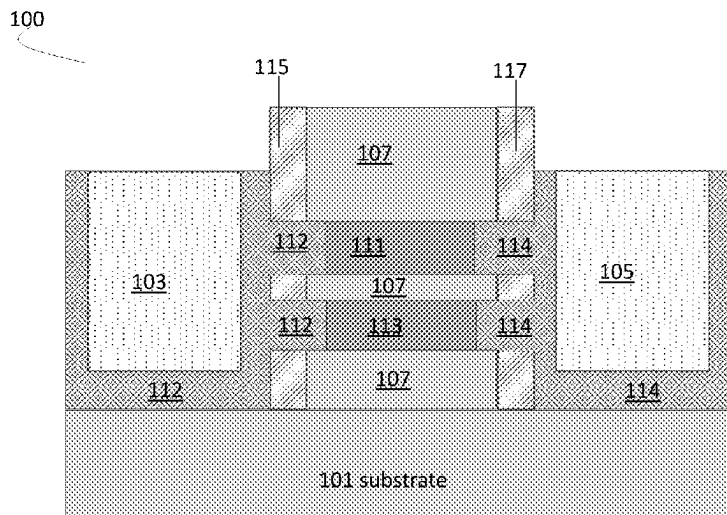
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(57) **ABSTRACT**

Embodiments herein describe techniques, systems, and  
method for a semiconductor device. A nanowire transistor  
may include a channel region including a nanowire above a  
substrate, a source electrode coupled to a first end of the  
nanowire through a first etch stop layer, and a drain electrode  
coupled to a second end of the nanowire through a second  
etch stop layer. A gate electrode may be above the substrate  
to control conductivity in at least a portion of the channel  
region. A first spacer may be above the substrate between the  
gate electrode and the source electrode, and a second spacer  
may be above the substrate between the gate electrode and  
the drain electrode. A gate dielectric layer may be between  
the channel region and the gate electrode. Other embodi-  
ments may be described and/or claimed.

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**84/0193**

See application file for complete search history.

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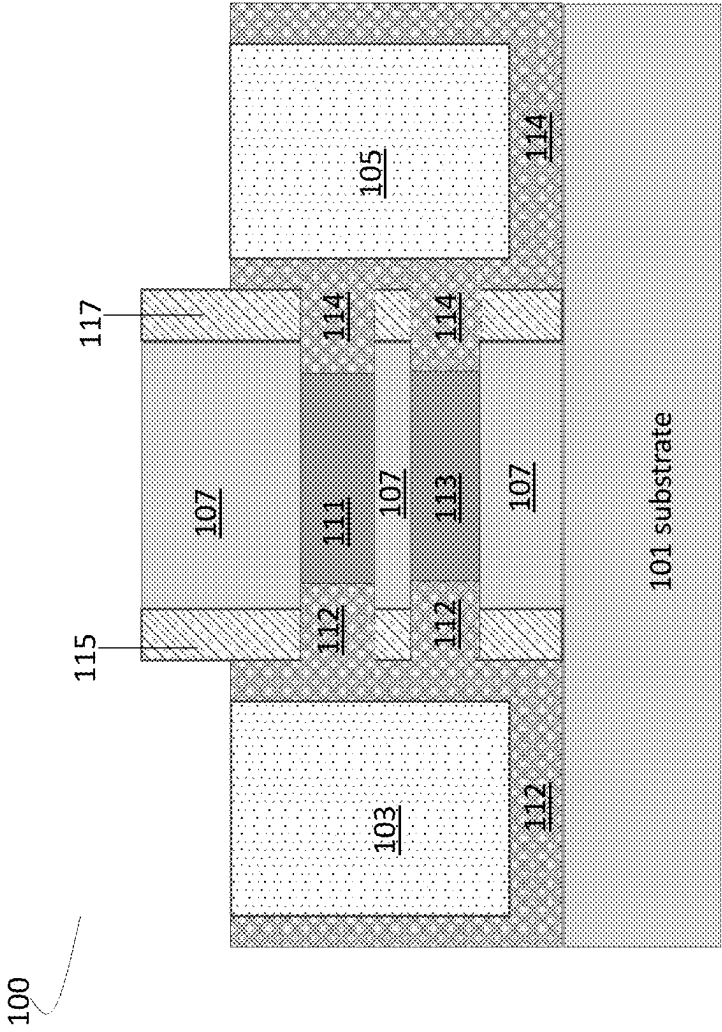


Figure 1

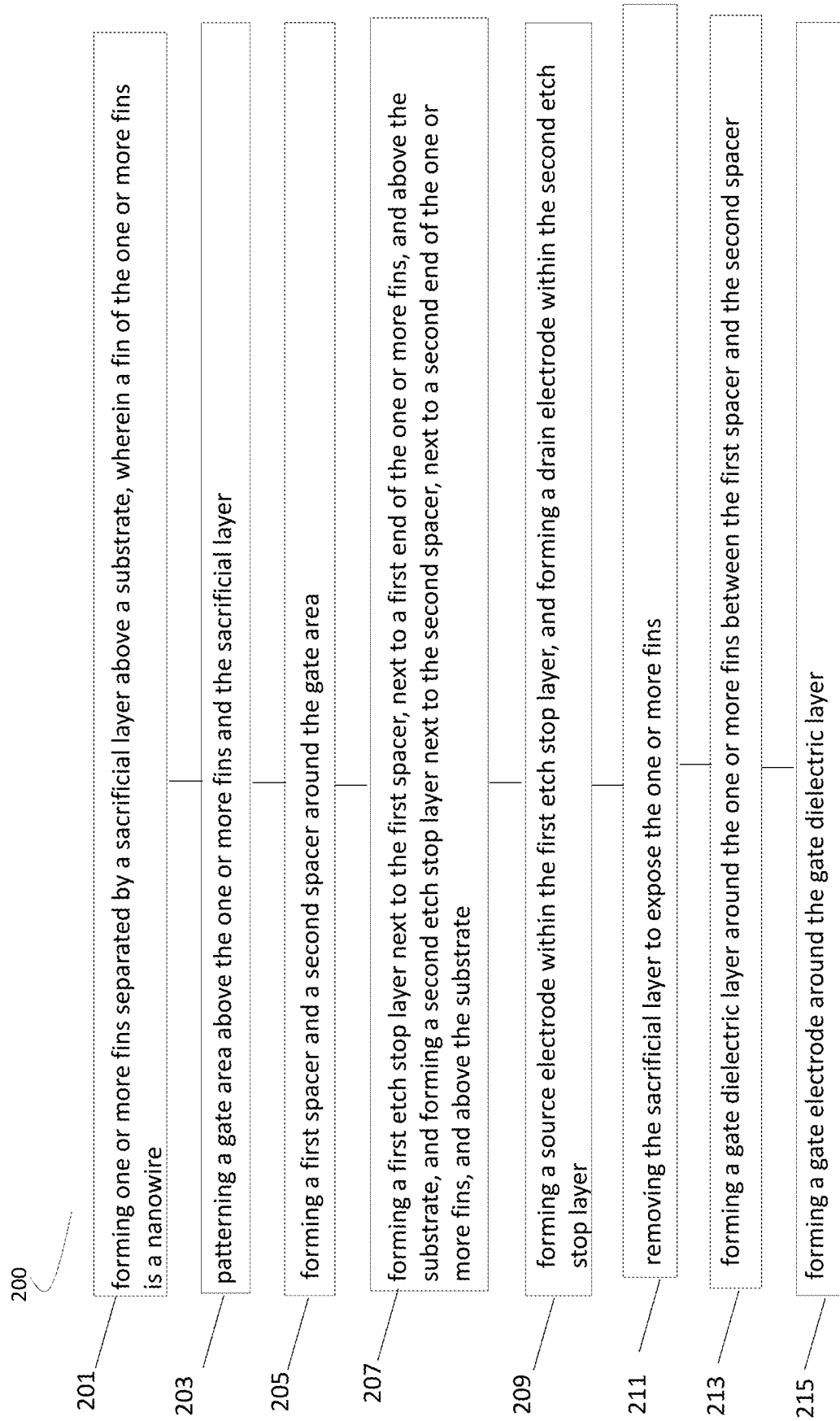


Figure 2

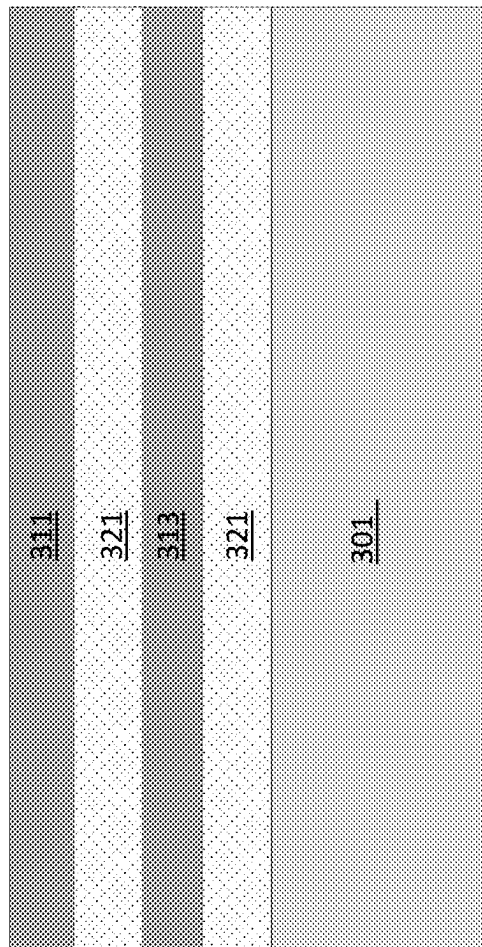


Figure 3

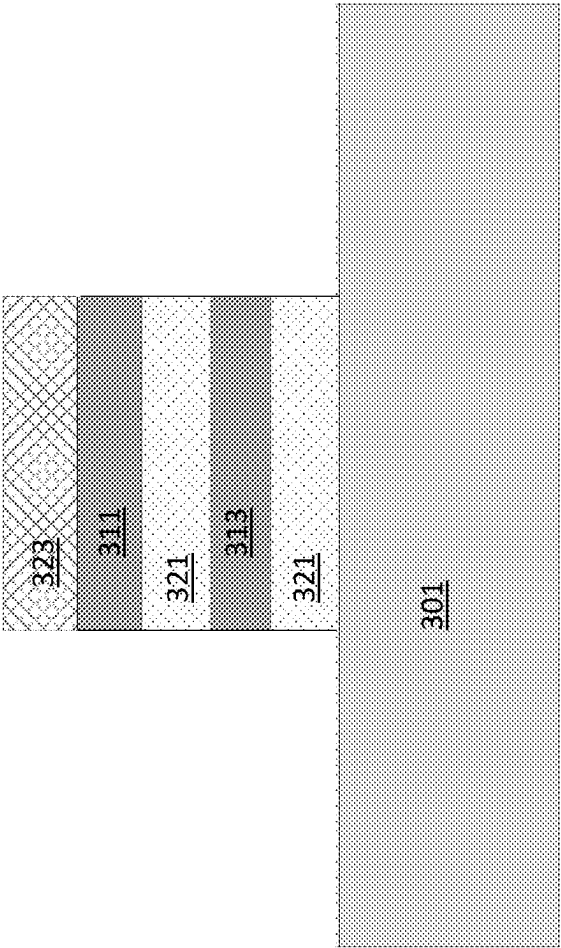


Figure 4

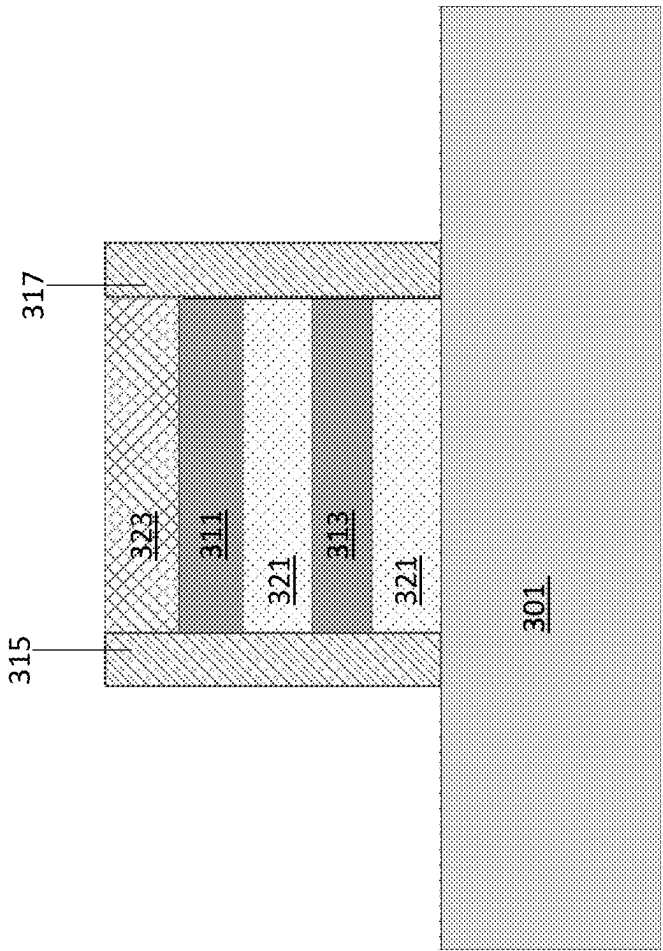


Figure 5

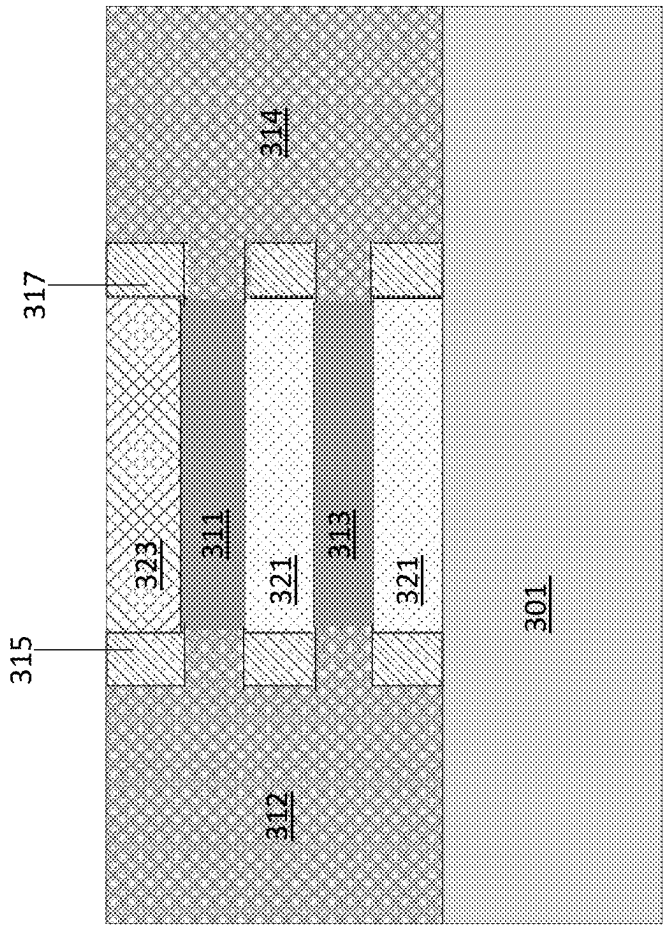


Figure 6



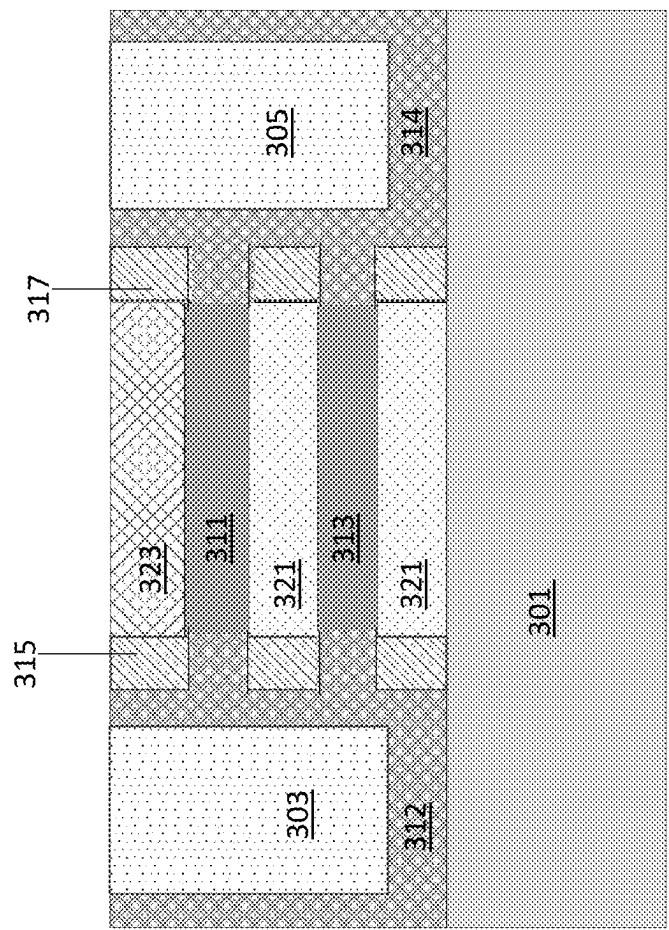


Figure 7

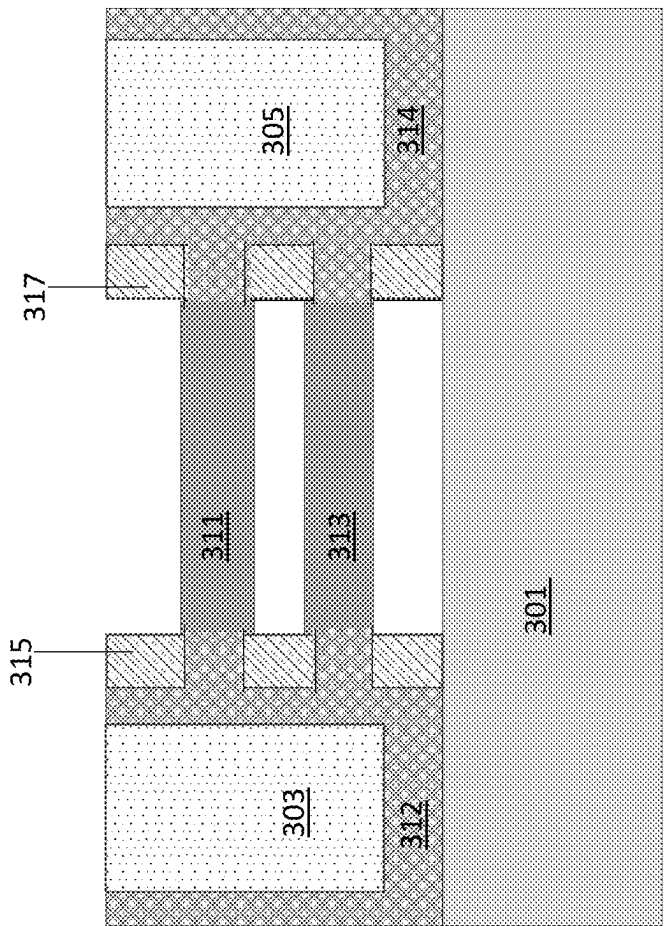


Figure 8

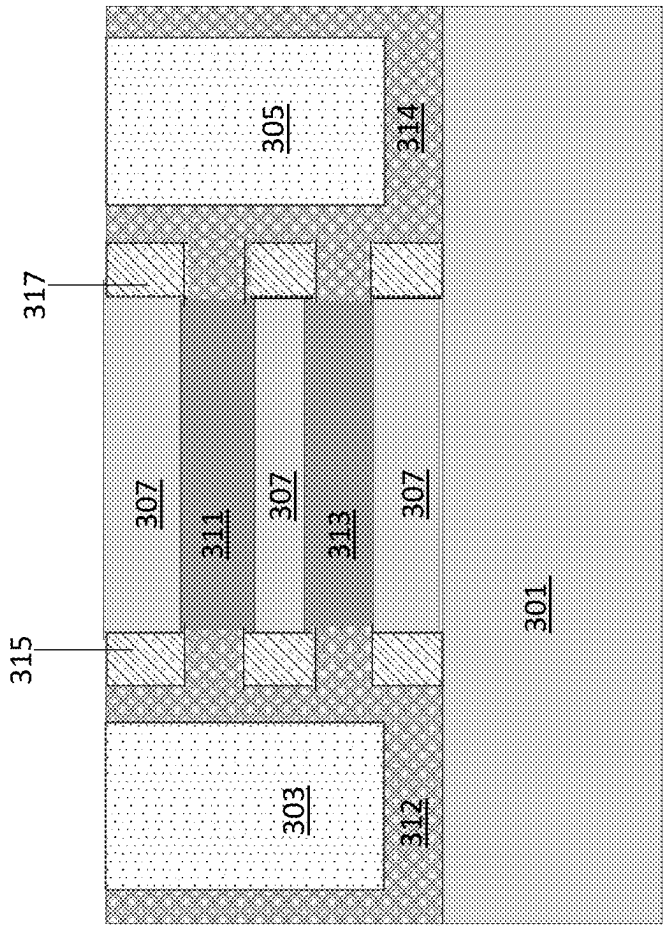


Figure 9

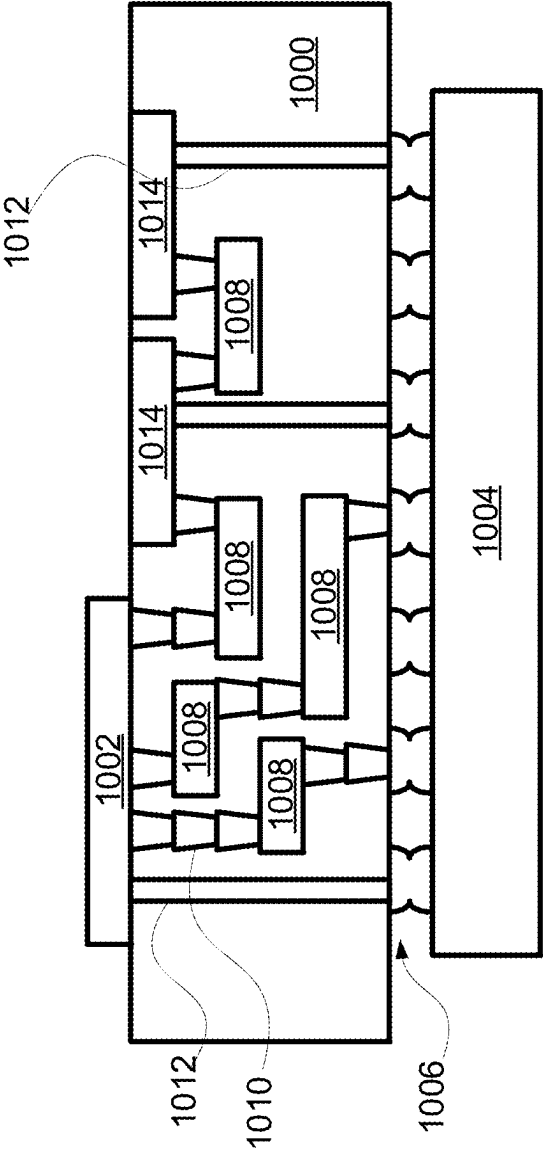


Figure 10

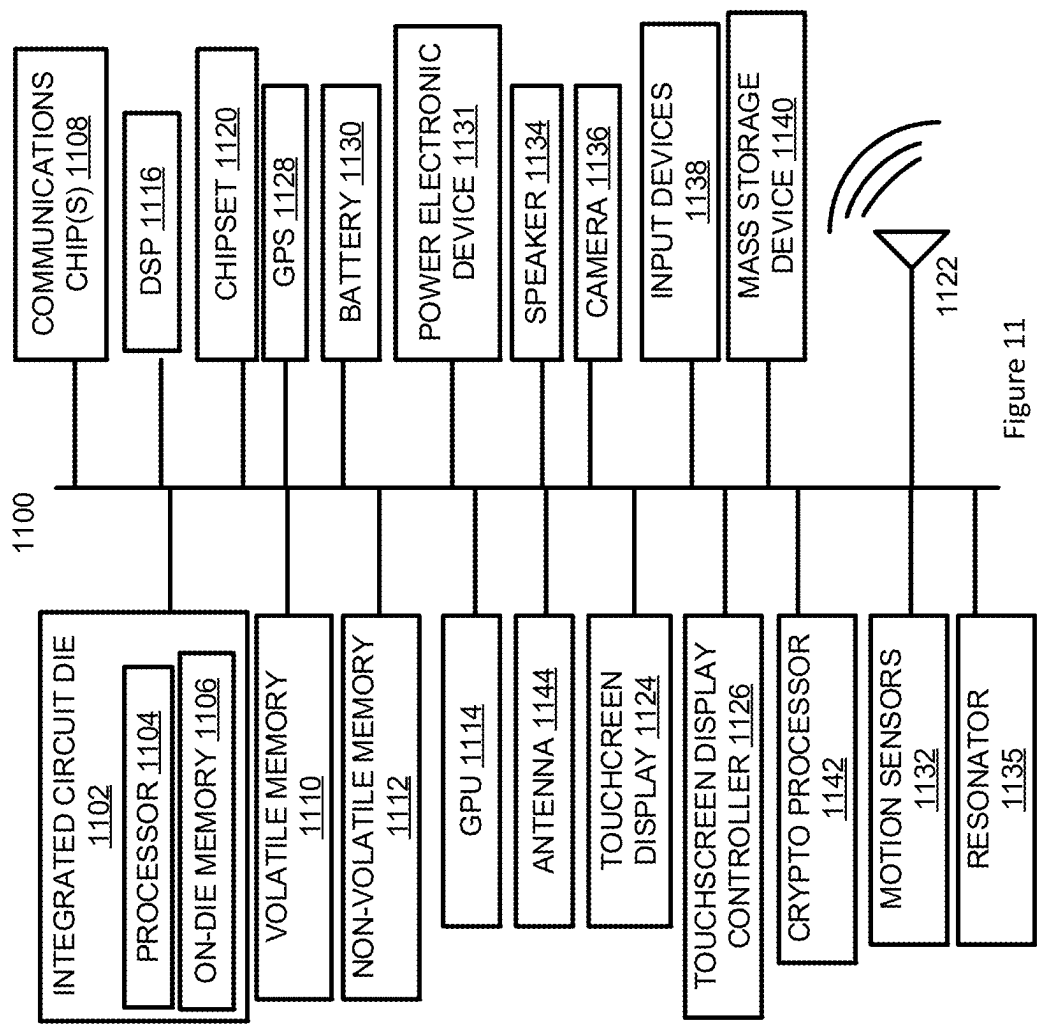


Figure 11

1

# **SOURCE ELECTRODE AND DRAIN ELECTRODE PROTECTION FOR NANOWIRE TRANSISTORS**

## **CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION**

This patent application is continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/646,124, filed Mar. 10, 2020, which is a U.S. National Phase Application under 35 U.S.C. § 371 of International Application No. PCT/US2017/068624, filed Dec. 28, 2017, entitled "SOURCE ELECTRODE AND DRAIN ELECTRODE PROTECTION FOR NANOWIRE TRANSISTORS," which designates the United States of America, the entire disclosure of which are hereby incorporated by reference in their entirety and for all purposes.

## **FIELD**

Embodiments of the present disclosure generally relate to the field of integrated circuits, and more particularly, to nanowire transistors.

## **BACKGROUND**

In a gate last or a replacement gate scheme for fabricating a nanowire transistor, a gate dielectric layer and a gate electrode may be formed after a source electrode and a drain electrode have been formed. Hence, a source electrode or a drain electrode may be partially removed unintentionally during the formation of the gate electrode, leading to poor transistor characteristics and reduced device yield. In addition, multiple stacked nanowires of a nanowire transistor contained within a small dimension, and a sacrificial layer around the nanowires having materials similar to a source electrode or a drain electrode, may further make the damages to the source electrode or the drain electrode worse.

## **BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS**

Embodiments will be readily understood by the following detailed description in conjunction with the accompanying drawings. To facilitate this description, like reference numerals designate like structural elements. Embodiments are illustrated by way of example and not by way of limitation in the figures of the accompanying drawings.

FIG. 1 schematically illustrates an example nanowire transistor including an etch stop layer between a source electrode or a drain electrode and a channel region including a nanowire, in accordance with some embodiments.

FIG. 2 illustrates a process for forming a nanowire transistor including an etch stop layer between a source electrode or a drain electrode and a channel region including a nanowire, in accordance with some embodiments.

FIGS. 3-9 illustrate various steps of a process for forming a nanowire transistor including an etch stop layer between a source electrode or a drain electrode and a channel region including a nanowire, in accordance with some embodiments.

FIG. 10 schematically illustrates an interposer implementing one or more embodiments of the disclosure, in accordance with some embodiments.

FIG. 11 schematically illustrates a computing device built in accordance with an embodiment of the disclosure, in accordance with some embodiments.

## **DETAILED DESCRIPTION**

A part of a source electrode or a part of a drain electrode of a nanowire transistor may be removed unintentionally in

2

a gate last fabrication scheme when a gate electrode is formed for the nanowire transistor. Some current solutions may increase a length of a nanowire channel, or increase a spacer thickness to protect the source electrode or the drain electrode from being damaged. Such solutions may result in a larger device with reduced drive current, reduced gate control, and reduced transistor density.

In embodiments, an etch stop layer may be formed between a source electrode and a nanowire in a channel region of a nanowire transistor. Similarly, an etch stop layer may be formed between a drain electrode and a nanowire in the channel region. The etch stop layer may include materials similar to the materials in the nanowire channels, with some added dopants to improve its etch resistance. Such an etch stop layer may prevent and protect a source electrode or a drain electrode from being removed unintentionally, without increasing the channel length or spacer thickness.

Embodiments herein may present a semiconductor device including a nanowire transistor. The nanowire transistor may include a substrate, a channel region including a nanowire above the substrate, a source electrode and a drain electrode above the substrate. The source electrode may be coupled to a first end of the nanowire through a first etch stop layer between the source electrode and the nanowire, and the drain electrode may be coupled to a second end of the nanowire through a second etch stop layer between the drain electrode and the nanowire. A gate electrode may be above the substrate to control conductivity in at least a portion of the channel region. A first spacer may be above the substrate between the gate electrode and the source electrode, and a second spacer may be above the substrate between the gate electrode and the drain electrode. A gate dielectric layer may be between the channel region and the gate electrode.

Embodiments herein may present a method for forming a nanowire transistor. The method may include forming one or more fins separated by a sacrificial layer above a substrate, where a fin of the one or more fins may be a nanowire. The method may further include patterning a gate area above the one or more fins and the sacrificial layer, and forming a first spacer and a second spacer around the gate area. In addition, the method may include forming a first etch stop layer next to the first spacer, next to a first end of the one or more fins, and above the substrate, and forming a second etch stop layer next to the second spacer, next to a second end of the one or more fins, and above the substrate. Furthermore, the method may include forming a source electrode within the first etch stop layer, and forming a drain electrode within the second etch stop layer. Moreover, the method may include removing the sacrificial layer to expose the one or more fins, forming a gate dielectric layer around the one or more fins between the first spacer and the second spacer, and forming a gate electrode around the gate dielectric layer.

Embodiments herein may present a computing device. The computing device may include a processor and a memory device coupled to the processor. The memory device or the processor may include a nanowire transistor. The nanowire transistor may include a substrate and a channel region including a nanowire above the substrate. A source electrode and a drain electrode may be above the substrate. The source electrode may be coupled to a first end of the nanowire through a first etch stop layer between the source electrode and the nanowire, and the drain electrode may be coupled to a second end of the nanowire through a second etch stop layer between the drain electrode and the nanowire. A gate electrode may be above the substrate to control conductivity in at least a portion of the channel region. A first spacer may be above the substrate between the

gate electrode and the source electrode, and a second spacer above the substrate between the gate electrode and the drain electrode. A gate dielectric layer may be between the channel region and the gate electrode.

In the following description, various aspects of the illustrative implementations will be described using terms commonly employed by those skilled in the art to convey the substance of their work to others skilled in the art. However, it will be apparent to those skilled in the art that the present disclosure may be practiced with only some of the described aspects. For purposes of explanation, specific numbers, materials and configurations are set forth in order to provide a thorough understanding of the illustrative implementations. However, it will be apparent to one skilled in the art that the present disclosure may be practiced without the specific details. In other instances, well-known features are omitted or simplified in order not to obscure the illustrative implementations.

Various operations will be described as multiple discrete operations, in turn, in a manner that is most helpful in understanding the present disclosure. However, the order of description should not be construed to imply that these operations are necessarily order dependent. In particular, these operations may not be performed in the order of presentation.

For the purposes of the present disclosure, the phrase “A and/or B” means (A), (B), or (A and B). For the purposes of the present disclosure, the phrase “A, B, and/or C” means (A), (B), (C), (A and B), (A and C), (B and C), or (A, B and C).

The terms “over,” “under,” “between,” “above,” and “on” as used herein may refer to a relative position of one material layer or component with respect to other layers or components. For example, one layer disposed over or under another layer may be directly in contact with the other layer or may have one or more intervening layers. Moreover, one layer disposed between two layers may be directly in contact with the two layers or may have one or more intervening layers. In contrast, a first layer “on” a second layer is in direct contact with that second layer. Similarly, unless explicitly stated otherwise, one feature disposed between two features may be in direct contact with the adjacent features or may have one or more intervening features.

The description may use the phrases “in an embodiment,” or “in embodiments,” which may each refer to one or more of the same or different embodiments. Furthermore, the terms “comprising,” “including,” “having,” and the like, as used with respect to embodiments of the present disclosure, are synonymous.

The term “coupled with,” along with its derivatives, may be used herein. “Coupled” may mean one or more of the following. “Coupled” may mean that two or more elements are in direct physical or electrical contact. However, “coupled” may also mean that two or more elements indirectly contact each other, but yet still cooperate or interact with each other, and may mean that one or more other elements are coupled or connected between the elements that are said to be coupled with each other. The term “directly coupled” may mean that two or more elements are in direct contact.

In various embodiments, the phrase “a first feature formed, deposited, or otherwise disposed on a second feature” may mean that the first feature is formed, deposited, or disposed over the second feature, and at least a part of the first feature may be in direct contact (e.g., direct physical and/or electrical contact) or indirect contact (e.g., having one

or more other features between the first feature and the second feature) with at least a part of the second feature.

Where the disclosure recites “a” or “a first” element or the equivalent thereof, such disclosure includes one or more such elements, neither requiring nor excluding two or more such elements. Further, ordinal indicators (e.g., first, second, or third) for identified elements are used to distinguish between the elements, and do not indicate or imply a required or limited number of such elements, nor do they indicate a particular position or order of such elements unless otherwise specifically stated.

As used herein, the term “circuitry” may refer to, be part of, or include an Application Specific Integrated Circuit (ASIC), an electronic circuit, a processor (shared, dedicated, or group), and/or memory (shared, dedicated, or group) that execute one or more software or firmware programs, a combinational logic circuit, and/or other suitable hardware components that provide the described functionality. As used herein, “computer-implemented method” may refer to any method executed by one or more processors, a computer system having one or more processors, a mobile device such as a smartphone (which may include one or more processors), a tablet, a laptop computer, a set-top box, a gaming console, and so forth.

Implementations of the disclosure may be formed or carried out on a substrate, such as a semiconductor substrate. In one implementation, the semiconductor substrate may be a crystalline substrate formed using a bulk silicon or a silicon-on-insulator substructure. In other implementations, the semiconductor substrate may be formed using alternate materials, which may or may not be combined with silicon, that include but are not limited to germanium, indium antimonide, lead telluride, indium arsenide, indium phosphide, gallium arsenide, indium gallium arsenide, gallium antimonide, or other combinations of group III-V or group IV materials. Although a few examples of materials from which the substrate may be formed are described here, any material that may serve as a foundation upon which a semiconductor device may be built falls within the spirit and scope of the present disclosure.

A plurality of transistors, such as metal-oxide-semiconductor field-effect transistors (MOSFET or simply MOS transistors), may be fabricated on the substrate. In various implementations of the disclosure, the MOS transistors may be planar transistors, nonplanar transistors, or a combination of both. Nonplanar transistors include FinFET transistors such as double-gate transistors and tri-gate transistors, and wrap-around or all-around gate transistors such as nanoribbon and nanowire transistors. Although the implementations described herein may illustrate only planar transistors, it should be noted that the disclosure may also be carried out using nonplanar transistors.

Each MOS transistor includes a gate stack formed of at least two layers, a gate dielectric layer and a gate electrode layer. The gate dielectric layer may include one layer or a stack of layers. The one or more layers may include silicon oxide, silicon dioxide (SiO<sub>2</sub>) and/or a high-k dielectric material. The high-k dielectric material may include elements such as hafnium, silicon, oxygen, titanium, tantalum, lanthanum, aluminum, zirconium, barium, strontium, yttrium, lead, scandium, niobium, and zinc. Examples of high-k materials that may be used in the gate dielectric layer include, but are not limited to, hafnium oxide, hafnium silicon oxide, lanthanum oxide, lanthanum aluminum oxide, zirconium oxide, zirconium silicon oxide, tantalum oxide, titanium oxide, barium strontium titanium oxide, barium titanium oxide, strontium titanium oxide, yttrium oxide,

aluminum oxide, lead scandium tantalum oxide, and lead zinc niobate. In some embodiments, an annealing process may be carried out on the gate dielectric layer to improve its quality when a high-k material is used.

The gate electrode layer is formed on the gate dielectric layer and may consist of at least one P-type work function metal or N-type work function metal, depending on whether the transistor is to be a PMOS or an NMOS transistor. In some implementations, the gate electrode layer may consist of a stack of two or more metal layers, where one or more metal layers are work function metal layers and at least one metal layer is a fill metal layer. Further metal layers may be included for other purposes, such as a barrier layer.

For a PMOS transistor, metals that may be used for the gate electrode include, but are not limited to, ruthenium, palladium, platinum, cobalt, nickel, and conductive metal oxides, e.g., ruthenium oxide. A P-type metal layer will enable the formation of a PMOS gate electrode with a work function that is between about 4.9 eV and about 5.2 eV. For an NMOS transistor, metals that may be used for the gate electrode include, but are not limited to, hafnium, zirconium, titanium, tantalum, aluminum, alloys of these metals, and carbides of these metals such as hafnium carbide, zirconium carbide, titanium carbide, tantalum carbide, and aluminum carbide. An N-type metal layer will enable the formation of an NMOS gate electrode with a work function that is between about 3.9 eV and about 4.2 eV.

In some implementations, when viewed as a cross-section of the transistor along the source-channel-drain direction, the gate electrode may consist of a "U"-shaped structure that includes a bottom portion substantially parallel to the surface of the substrate and two sidewall portions that are substantially perpendicular to the top surface of the substrate. In another implementation, at least one of the metal layers that form the gate electrode may simply be a planar layer that is substantially parallel to the top surface of the substrate and does not include sidewall portions substantially perpendicular to the top surface of the substrate. In further implementations of the disclosure, the gate electrode may consist of a combination of U-shaped structures and planar, non-U-shaped structures. For example, the gate electrode may consist of one or more U-shaped metal layers formed atop one or more planar, non-U-shaped layers.

In some implementations of the disclosure, a pair of sidewall spacers may be formed on opposing sides of the gate stack that bracket the gate stack. The sidewall spacers may be formed from a material such as silicon nitride, silicon oxide, silicon carbide, silicon nitride doped with carbon, and silicon oxynitride. Processes for forming sidewall spacers are well known in the art and generally include deposition and etching process operations. In an alternate implementation, a plurality of spacer pairs may be used, for instance, two pairs, three pairs, or four pairs of sidewall spacers may be formed on opposing sides of the gate stack.

As is well known in the art, source and drain regions are formed within the substrate adjacent to the gate stack of each MOS transistor. The source and drain regions are generally formed using either an implantation/diffusion process or an etching/deposition process. In the former process, dopants such as boron, aluminum, antimony, phosphorous, or arsenic may be ion-implanted into the substrate to form the source and drain regions. An annealing process that activates the dopants and causes them to diffuse further into the substrate typically follows the ion implantation process. In the latter process, the substrate may first be etched to form recesses at the locations of the source and drain regions. An epitaxial deposition process may then be carried out to fill the recesses

with material that is used to fabricate the source and drain regions. In some implementations, the source and drain regions may be fabricated using a silicon alloy such as silicon germanium or silicon carbide. In some implementations the epitaxially deposited silicon alloy may be doped in situ with dopants such as boron, arsenic, or phosphorous. In further embodiments, the source and drain regions may be formed using one or more alternate semiconductor materials such as germanium or a group III-V material or alloy. And in further embodiments, one or more layers of metal and/or metal alloys may be used to form the source and drain regions.

One or more interlayer dielectrics (ILD) are deposited over the MOS transistors. The ILD layers may be formed using dielectric materials known for their applicability in integrated circuit structures, such as low-k dielectric materials. Examples of dielectric materials that may be used include, but are not limited to, silicon dioxide (SiO<sub>2</sub>), carbon doped oxide (CDO), silicon nitride, organic polymers such as perfluorocyclobutane or polytetrafluoroethylene, fluorosilicate glass (FSG), and organosilicates such as silsesquioxane, siloxane, or organosilicate glass. The ILD layers may include pores or air gaps to further reduce their dielectric constant.

FIG. 1 schematically illustrates an example nanowire transistor **100** including an etch stop layer, e.g., an etch stop layer **112**, or an etch stop layer **114**, between a source electrode **103** or a drain electrode **105** and a channel region including a nanowire, e.g., a nanowire **111** or a nanowire **113**, in accordance with some embodiments. For clarity, features of the nanowire transistor **100**, the etch stop layer **112**, the etch stop layer **114**, the source electrode **103**, the drain electrode **105**, the nanowire **111**, and the nanowire **113**, may be described below as examples for understanding a nanowire transistor, an etch stop layer, a source electrode, a drain electrode, and a nanowire. Further, it is to be understood that one or more of the components of a nanowire transistor, an etch stop layer, a source electrode, a drain electrode, and a nanowire may include additional and/or varying features from the description below, and may include any device that one having ordinary skill in the art would consider and/or refer to as a nanowire transistor, an etch stop layer, a source electrode, a drain electrode, and a nanowire.

In embodiments, the nanowire transistor **100** may be an n-type transistor or a p-type transistor. The nanowire transistor **100** may include a substrate **101**, a channel region including a nanowire **111** and a nanowire **113** above the substrate **101**, the source electrode **103** above the substrate **101**, the drain electrode **105** above the substrate **101**, the etch stop layer **112**, the etch stop layer **114**, a gate electrode **107**, a spacer **115** above the substrate **101** between the gate electrode **107** and the source electrode **103**, and a spacer **117** above the substrate **101** between the gate electrode **107** and the drain electrode **105**.

In embodiments, the nanowire **111** or the nanowire **113** may be a rectangular nanowire, a circular nanowire, or a nanoribbon. The nanowire **111** or the nanowire **113** may include Si, Ge, Sn, In, Ga, As, Al, InAs, SiGe, InGaAs, InP, or a metal oxide.

In embodiments, the source electrode **103** may be coupled to a first end of the nanowire **111** and the nanowire **113** through the etch stop layer **112** between the source electrode **103** and the nanowire **111** and the nanowire **113**. In addition, the etch stop layer **112** may be around sidewalls of the source electrode **103**, between the source electrode **103** and the substrate **101**. Similarly, the drain electrode **105** may be



coupled to a second end of the nanowire **111** and the nanowire **113** through the etch stop layer **114** between the drain electrode **105** and the nanowire **111** and the nanowire **113**, and the etch stop layer **114** may be around sidewalls of the drain electrode **105**, between the drain electrode **105** and the substrate **101**. The etch stop layer **112** or the etch stop layer **114** may include materials similar to the materials in the nanowire **111** and the nanowire **113**, with some added dopants to improve the etch resistance. For example, the etch stop layer **112** or the etch stop layer **114** may be doped with boron (B) or phosphorus (P). In some embodiments, the etch stop layer **112** or the etch stop layer **114** may include boron doped Si, boron doped Ge, boron doped SiGe, phosphorus doped Si, phosphorus doped Ge, or phosphorus doped SiGe. The etch stop layer **112** or the etch stop layer **114** may have a thickness between the source electrode and the nanowire less than 25 nanometer (nm).

In embodiments, the gate electrode **107** may be above the substrate **101** to control conductivity in at least a portion of the channel region, e.g., the nanowire **111** and the nanowire **113**. The gate electrode **107** may be around the nanowire **111** and the nanowire **113**. A gate dielectric layer, not shown, may be between the channel region, e.g., the nanowire **111** and the nanowire **113**, and the gate electrode **107**. In some embodiments, the gate dielectric layer may include silicon and oxygen, silicon and nitrogen, yttrium and oxygen, silicon, oxygen, and nitrogen, aluminum and oxygen, hafnium and oxygen, tantalum and oxygen, or titanium and oxygen. For example, the gate dielectric layer may include silicon oxide (SiO<sub>2</sub>), silicon nitride (SiN<sub>x</sub>), yttrium oxide (Y<sub>2</sub>O<sub>3</sub>), silicon oxynitride (SiO<sub>x</sub>N<sub>y</sub>), aluminum oxide (Al<sub>2</sub>O<sub>3</sub>), hafnium(IV) oxide (HfO<sub>2</sub>), tantalum oxide (Ta<sub>2</sub>O<sub>5</sub>), titanium dioxide (TiO<sub>2</sub>), or other materials.

In embodiments, the substrate **101** may be a silicon substrate, a glass substrate, such as soda lime glass or borosilicate glass, a metal substrate, a plastic substrate, a polyimide substrate, or other suitable substrate. The substrate **101** may include silicon, sapphire, SiC, GaN, or AlN.

In embodiments, the source electrode **103**, the drain electrode **105**, or the gate electrode **107** may be formed as a single layer or a stacked layer using one or more conductive films including a conductive material. For example, the source electrode **103**, the drain electrode **105**, or the gate electrode **107** may include a metallic material, a conductive polymer, a polysilicon, a titanium silicide, a phosphorus (n+) doped Si, a boron doped SiGe, or an alloy of a semiconductor material and a metal. For example, the source electrode **103**, the drain electrode **105**, or the gate electrode **107** may include gold (Au), platinum (Pt), ruthenium (Ru), iridium (Ir), titanium (Ti), aluminum (Al), molybdenum (Mo), copper (Cu), tantalum (Ta), tungsten (W), nickel (Ni), chromium (Cr), hafnium (Hf), indium (In), or an alloy of Ti, Mo, Au, Pt, Al Ni, Cu, Cr, TiAlN, HfAlN, or InAlO. The source electrode **103**, the drain electrode **105**, or the gate electrode **107** may include tantalum nitride (TaN), titanium nitride (TiN), iridium-tantalum alloy (Ir—Ta), indium-tin oxide (ITO), the like, and/or a combination thereof.

FIG. 2 illustrates a process **200** for forming a nanowire transistor including an etch stop layer between a source electrode or a drain electrode and a channel region including a nanowire, in accordance with some embodiments. Similarly, FIGS. 3-9 illustrate various steps of a process for forming a nanowire transistor including an etch stop layer between a source electrode or a drain electrode and a channel region including a nanowire. In embodiments, the process **200** may be used to form a nanowire transistor including an etch stop layer between a source electrode or a

drain electrode and a channel region including a nanowire, similar to the nanowire transistor **100** in FIG. 1. FIGS. 3-9 may illustrate more details of the process **200** shown in FIG. 2.

At block **201**, the process **200** may include forming one or more fins separated by a sacrificial layer above a substrate, wherein a fin of the one or more fins is a nanowire. For example, as shown in FIG. 3, the process **200** may include a fin **311**, and a fin **313**, separated by a sacrificial layer **321** above a substrate **301**. The fin **311** or the fin **313** may be a nanowire.

At block **203**, the process **200** may include patterning a gate area above the one or more fins and the sacrificial layer. For example, as shown in FIG. 4, the process **200** may include forming a gate area defined by a dummy gate **323** above the fin **311**, the fin **313**, and the sacrificial layer **321**.

At block **205**, the process **200** may include forming a first spacer and a second spacer around the gate area. For example, as shown in FIG. 5, the process **200** may include forming a first spacer **315** and a second spacer **317** around the gate area, which may be defined by the dummy gate **323**.

At block **207**, the process **200** may include forming a first etch stop layer next to the first spacer, next to a first end of the one or more fins, and above the substrate, and forming a second etch stop layer next to the second spacer, next to a second end of the one or more fins, and above the substrate. For example, as shown in FIG. 6, the process **200** may include forming a first etch stop layer **312** and a second etch stop layer **314**. The first etch stop layer **312** may be next to the first spacer **315**, next to a first end of the fin **311** and the fin **313**, and above the substrate **301**. The second etch stop layer **314** may be next to the second spacer **317**, next to a second end of the fin **311** and the fin **313**, and above the substrate **301**.

At block **209**, the process **200** may include forming a source electrode within the first etch stop layer, and forming a drain electrode within the second etch stop layer. For example, as shown in FIG. 7, the process **200** may include forming a source electrode **303** within the first etch stop layer **312**, and forming a drain electrode **305** within the second etch stop layer **314**.

At block **211**, the process **200** may include removing the sacrificial layer to expose the one or more fins. For example, as shown in FIG. 8, the process **200** may include removing the sacrificial layer **321** to expose the fin **311** and the fin **313**. In addition, the dummy gate **323** above the sacrificial layer **321** may be removed as well.

At block **213**, the process **200** may include forming a gate dielectric layer around the one or more fins between the first spacer and the second spacer. At block **215**, the process **200** may include forming a gate electrode around the gate dielectric layer. For example, as shown in FIG. 9, the process **200** may include forming a gate dielectric layer, not shown, around the fin **311** and the fin **313** between the first spacer **315** and the second spacer **317**, and further forming a gate electrode **307** around the gate dielectric layer.

FIG. 10 illustrates an interposer **1000** that includes one or more embodiments of the disclosure. The interposer **1000** is an intervening substrate used to bridge a first substrate **1002** to a second substrate **1004**. The first substrate **1002** may be, for instance, a substrate support the nanowire transistor **100** including the etch stop layer **112**, or the etch stop layer **114**, between the source electrode **103** or the drain electrode **105** and a channel region including the nanowire **111** and the nanowire **113**, shown in FIG. 1. The second substrate **1004** may be, for instance, a memory module, a computer motherboard, or another integrated circuit die. Generally, the

purpose of an interposer **1000** is to spread a connection to a wider pitch or to reroute a connection to a different connection. For example, an interposer **1000** may couple an integrated circuit die to a ball grid array (BGA) **1006** that can subsequently be coupled to the second substrate **1004**. In some embodiments, the first and second substrates **1002/1004** are attached to opposing sides of the interposer **1000**. In other embodiments, the first and second substrates **1002/1004** are attached to the same side of the interposer **1000**. And in further embodiments, three or more substrates are interconnected by way of the interposer **1000**.

The interposer **1000** may be formed of an epoxy resin, a fiberglass-reinforced epoxy resin, a ceramic material, or a polymer material such as polyimide. In further implementations, the interposer may be formed of alternate rigid or flexible materials that may include the same materials described above for use in a semiconductor substrate, such as silicon, germanium, and other group III-V and group IV materials.

The interposer may include metal interconnects **1008** and vias **1010**, including but not limited to through-silicon vias (TSVs) **1012**. The interposer **1000** may further include embedded devices **1014**, including both passive and active devices. Such devices include, but are not limited to, capacitors, decoupling capacitors, resistors, inductors, fuses, diodes, transformers, sensors, and electrostatic discharge (ESD) devices. More complex devices such as radio-frequency (RF) devices, power amplifiers, power management devices, antennas, arrays, sensors, and MEMS devices may also be formed on the interposer **1000**.

In accordance with embodiments of the disclosure, apparatuses or processes disclosed herein may be used in the fabrication of interposer **1000**.

FIG. **11** illustrates a computing device **1100** in accordance with one embodiment of the disclosure. The computing device **1100** may include a number of components. In one embodiment, these components are attached to one or more motherboards. In an alternate embodiment, some or all of these components are fabricated onto a single system-on-a-chip (SoC) die, such as a SoC used for mobile devices. The components in the computing device **1100** include, but are not limited to, an integrated circuit die **1102** and at least one communications logic unit **1108**. In some implementations the communications logic unit **1108** is fabricated within the integrated circuit die **1102** while in other implementations the communications logic unit **1108** is fabricated in a separate integrated circuit chip that may be bonded to a substrate or motherboard that is shared with or electronically coupled to the integrated circuit die **1102**. The integrated circuit die **1102** may include a processor **1104** as well as on-die memory **1106**, often used as cache memory, which can be provided by technologies such as embedded DRAM (eDRAM), or SRAM. For example, the processor **1104** or the on-die memory **1106**, or other control circuits in the integrated circuit die **1102** may include the nanowire transistor **100** including the etch stop layer **112**, or the etch stop layer **114**, between the source electrode **103** or the drain electrode **105** and a channel region including the nanowire **111** and the nanowire **113**, shown in FIG. **1**, or a nanowire transistor formed following the process **200** shown in FIG. **2**.

In embodiments, the computing device **1100** may include a display or a touchscreen display **1124**, and a touchscreen display controller **1126**. A display or the touchscreen display **1124** may include a FPD, an AMOLED display, a TFT LCD, a micro light-emitting diode ( $\mu$ LED) display, or others.

Computing device **1100** may include other components that may or may not be physically and electrically coupled to the motherboard or fabricated within a SoC die. These other components include, but are not limited to, volatile memory **1110** (e.g., dynamic random access memory (DRAM)), non-volatile memory **1112** (e.g., ROM or flash memory), a graphics processing unit **1114** (GPU), a digital signal processor (DSP) **1116**, a crypto processor **1142** (e.g., a specialized processor that executes cryptographic algorithms within hardware), a chipset **1120**, at least one antenna **1122** (in some implementations two or more antenna may be used), a battery **1130** or other power source, a power electronic device **1131**, a voltage regulator (not shown), a global positioning system (GPS) device **1128**, a compass, a motion coprocessor or sensors **1132** (that may include an accelerometer, a gyroscope, and a compass), a microphone (not shown), a speaker **1134**, a resonator **1135**, a camera **1136**, user input devices **1138** (such as a keyboard, mouse, stylus, and touchpad), and a mass storage device **1140** (such as hard disk drive, compact disk (CD), digital versatile disk (DVD), and so forth). In embodiments, various components may include the nanowire transistor **100** including the etch stop layer **112**, or the etch stop layer **114**, between the source electrode **103** or the drain electrode **105** and a channel region including the nanowire **111** and the nanowire **113**, shown in FIG. **1**, or a nanowire transistor formed following the process **200** shown in FIG. **2**.

The computing device **1100** may incorporate further transmission, telecommunication, or radio functionality not already described herein. In some implementations, the computing device **1100** includes a radio that is used to communicate over a distance by modulating and radiating electromagnetic waves in air or space. In further implementations, the computing device **1100** includes a transmitter and a receiver (or a transceiver) that is used to communicate over a distance by modulating and radiating electromagnetic waves in air or space.

The communications logic unit **1108** enables wireless communications for the transfer of data to and from the computing device **1100**. The term “wireless” and its derivatives may be used to describe circuits, devices, systems, methods, techniques, communications channels, etc., that may communicate data through the use of modulated electromagnetic radiation through a non-solid medium. The term does not imply that the associated devices do not contain any wires, although in some embodiments they might not. The communications logic unit **1108** may implement any of a number of wireless standards or protocols, including but not limited to Wi-Fi (IEEE 802.11 family), WiMAX (IEEE 802.16 family), IEEE 802.20, long term evolution (LTE), Ev-DO, HSPA+, HSDPA+, HSUPA+, EDGE, GSM, GPRS, CDMA, TDMA, DECT, Infrared (IR), Near Field Communication (NFC), Bluetooth, derivatives thereof, as well as any other wireless protocols that are designated as 3G, 4G, 5G, and beyond. The computing device **1100** may include a plurality of communications logic units **1108**. For instance, a first communications logic unit **1108** may be dedicated to shorter range wireless communications such as Wi-Fi, NFC, and Bluetooth and a second communications logic unit **1108** may be dedicated to longer range wireless communications such as GPS, EDGE, GPRS, CDMA, WiMAX, LTE, Ev-DO, and others.

The processor **1104** of the computing device **1100** includes one or more devices, such as transistors. The term “processor” may refer to any device or portion of a device that processes electronic data from registers and/or memory to transform that electronic data into other electronic data

## 11

that may be stored in registers and/or memory. The communications logic unit **1108** may also include one or more devices, such as transistors.

In further embodiments, another component housed within the computing device **1100** may contain one or more devices, such as the power electronic device **1131**, that are formed in accordance with implementations of the current disclosure, e.g., the nanowire transistor **100** including the etch stop layer **112**, or the etch stop layer **114**, between the source electrode **103** or the drain electrode **105** and a channel region including the nanowire **111** and the nanowire **113**, shown in FIG. 1, or a nanowire transistor formed following the process **200** shown in FIG. 2.

In various embodiments, the computing device **1100** may be a laptop computer, a netbook computer, a notebook computer, an ultrabook computer, a smartphone, a dumbphone, a tablet, a tablet/laptop hybrid, a personal digital assistant (PDA), an ultra mobile PC, a mobile phone, a desktop computer, a server, a printer, a scanner, a monitor, a set-top box, an entertainment control unit, a digital camera, a portable music player, or a digital video recorder. In further implementations, the computing device **1100** may be any other electronic device that processes data.

Some non-limiting Examples are provided below.

Example 1 may include a semiconductor device including a nanowire transistor, comprising: a substrate; a channel region including a nanowire above the substrate; a source electrode and a drain electrode above the substrate, wherein the source electrode is coupled to a first end of the nanowire through a first etch stop layer between the source electrode and the nanowire, and the drain electrode is coupled to a second end of the nanowire through a second etch stop layer between the drain electrode and the nanowire; a gate electrode above the substrate to control conductivity in at least a portion of the channel region; a first spacer above the substrate between the gate electrode and the source electrode, a second spacer above the substrate between the gate electrode and the drain electrode; and a gate dielectric layer between the channel region and the gate electrode.

Example 2 may include the semiconductor device of example 1 and/or some other examples herein, wherein the nanowire is a first nanowire, and the channel region further includes a second nanowire, the source electrode is coupled to a first end of the second nanowire through the first etch stop layer between the source electrode and the second nanowire, and the drain electrode is coupled to a second end of the second nanowire through the second etch stop layer between the drain electrode and the second nanowire.

Example 3 may include the semiconductor device of any one of examples 1-2 and/or some other examples herein, wherein the first etch stop layer is around sidewalls of the source electrode, between the source electrode and the substrate, and the second etch stop layer is around sidewalls of the drain electrode, between the drain electrode and the substrate.

Example 4 may include the semiconductor device of any one of examples 1-2 and/or some other examples herein, wherein the gate electrode is around the nanowire.

Example 5 may include the semiconductor device of any one of examples 1-2 and/or some other examples herein, wherein the nanowire transistor is a n-type transistor or a p-type transistor.

Example 6 may include the semiconductor device of any one of examples 1-2 and/or some other examples herein, wherein the nanowire is a rectangular nanowire, a circular nanowire, or a nanoribbon.

## 12

Example 7 may include the semiconductor device of any one of examples 1-2 and/or some other examples herein, wherein the first etch stop layer has a thickness between the source electrode and the nanowire less than 25 nm.

Example 8 may include the semiconductor device of any one of examples 1-2 and/or some other examples herein, wherein the nanowire includes Si, Ge, Sn, In, Ga, As, Al, InAs, SiGe, InGaAs, InP, or a metal oxide.

Example 9 may include the semiconductor device of any one of examples 1-2 and/or some other examples herein, wherein the first etch stop layer or the second etch stop layer is doped with boron (B) or phosphorus (P).

Example 10 may include the semiconductor device of any one of examples 1-2 and/or some other examples herein, wherein the first etch stop layer or the second etch stop layer includes boron doped Si, boron doped Ge, boron doped SiGe, phosphorus doped Si, phosphorus doped Ge, or phosphorus doped SiGe.

Example 11 may include the semiconductor device of any one of examples 1-2 and/or some other examples herein, wherein the source electrode, the drain electrode, or the gate electrode includes a metallic material, a conductive polymer, a phosphorus (n+) doped Si, a polysilicon, a titanium silicide, a boron doped SiGe, or an alloy of a semiconductor material and a metal.

Example 12 may include the semiconductor device of any one of examples 1-2 and/or some other examples herein, wherein the substrate includes silicon, sapphire, glass, polyimide, SiC, GaN, or AlN.

Example 13 may include a method for forming a nanowire transistor, the method comprising: forming one or more fins separated by a sacrificial layer above a substrate, wherein a fin of the one or more fins is a nanowire; patterning a gate area above the one or more fins and the sacrificial layer; forming a first spacer and a second spacer around the gate area; forming a first etch stop layer next to the first spacer, next to a first end of the one or more fins, and above the substrate, and forming a second etch stop layer next to the second spacer, next to a second end of the one or more fins, and above the substrate; forming a source electrode within the first etch stop layer, and forming a drain electrode within the second etch stop layer; removing the sacrificial layer to expose the one or more fins; forming a gate dielectric layer around the one or more fins between the first spacer and the second spacer; and forming a gate electrode around the gate dielectric layer.

Example 14 may include the method of example 13 and/or some other examples herein, wherein the nanowire transistor is a n-type transistor or a p-type transistor.

Example 15 may include the method of any one of examples 13-14 and/or some other examples herein, wherein the nanowire is a rectangular nanowire, a circular nanowire, or a nanoribbon.

Example 16 may include the method of any one of examples 13-14 and/or some other examples herein, wherein the nanowire includes Si, Ge, Sn, In, Ga, As, Al, InAs, SiGe, InGaAs, InP, or a metal oxide.

Example 17 may include the method of any one of examples 13-14 and/or some other examples herein, wherein the first etch stop layer or the second etch stop layer is doped with boron (B) or phosphorus (P).

Example 18 may include the method of any one of examples 13-14 and/or some other examples herein, wherein the first etch stop layer or the second etch stop layer includes boron doped Si, boron doped Ge, boron doped SiGe, phosphorus doped Si, phosphorus doped Ge, or phosphorus doped SiGe.

## 13

Example 19 may include the method of any one of examples 13-14 and/or some other examples herein, wherein the source electrode, the drain electrode, or the gate electrode includes a metallic material, a conductive polymer, a polysilicon, a titanium silicide, a phosphorus (n+) doped Si, a boron doped SiGe, or an alloy of a semiconductor material and a metal.

Example 20 may include the method of any one of examples 13-14 and/or some other examples herein, wherein the substrate includes silicon, sapphire, glass, polyimide, SiC, GaN, or AlN.

Example 21 may include a computing device, comprising: a processor; and a memory device coupled to the processor, wherein the memory device or the processor includes a nanowire transistor comprising: a substrate; a channel region including a nanowire above the substrate; a source electrode and a drain electrode above the substrate, wherein the source electrode is coupled to a first end of the nanowire through a first etch stop layer between the source electrode and the nanowire, and the drain electrode is coupled to a second end of the nanowire through a second etch stop layer between the drain electrode and the nanowire; a gate electrode above the substrate to control conductivity in at least a portion of the channel region; a first spacer above the substrate between the gate electrode and the source electrode, a second spacer above the substrate between the gate electrode and the drain electrode; and a gate dielectric layer between the channel region and the gate electrode.

Example 22 may include the computing device of example 21 and/or some other examples herein, wherein the nanowire is a first nanowire, and the channel region further includes a second nanowire, the source electrode is coupled to a first end of the second nanowire through the first etch stop layer between the source electrode and the second nanowire, and the drain electrode is coupled to a second end of the second nanowire through the second etch stop layer between the drain electrode and the second nanowire.

Example 23 may include the computing device of any one of examples 21-22 and/or some other examples herein, wherein the first etch stop layer is around sidewalls of the source electrode, between the source electrode and the substrate, and the second etch stop layer is around sidewalls of the drain electrode, between the drain electrode and the substrate.

Example 24 may include the computing device of any one of examples 21-22 and/or some other examples herein, wherein the nanowire is a rectangular nanowire, a circular nanowire, or a nanoribbon.

Example 25 may include the computing device of any one of examples 21-22 and/or some other examples herein, wherein the computing device is a wearable device or a mobile computing device, the wearable device or the mobile computing device including one or more of an antenna, a touchscreen controller, a battery, an audio codec, a video codec, a power amplifier, a global positioning system (GPS) device, a compass, a Geiger counter, an accelerometer, a gyroscope, a speaker, or a camera coupled with the processor.

Example 26 may include one or more computer-readable media having instructions for forming a nanowire transistor, upon execution of the instructions by one or more processors, to perform the method of any one of examples 13-20.

Example 27 may include an apparatus for forming a semiconductor device, the apparatus comprising: means for forming one or more fins separated by a sacrificial layer above a substrate, wherein a fin of the one or more fins is a nanowire; means for patterning a gate area above the one or

## 14

more fins and the sacrificial layer; means for forming a first spacer and a second spacer around the gate area; means for forming a first etch stop layer next to the first spacer, next to a first end of the one or more fins, and above the substrate, and means for forming a second etch stop layer next to the second spacer, next to a second end of the one or more fins, and above the substrate; means for forming a source electrode within the first etch stop layer, and means for forming a drain electrode within the second etch stop layer; means for removing the sacrificial layer to expose the one or more fins; means for forming a gate dielectric layer around the one or more fins between the first spacer and the second spacer; and means for forming a gate electrode around the gate dielectric layer.

Example 28 may include the apparatus of example 27 and/or some other examples herein, wherein the nanowire transistor is a n-type transistor or a p-type transistor.

Example 29 may include the apparatus of any one of examples 27-28 and/or some other examples herein, wherein the nanowire is a rectangular nanowire, a circular nanowire, or a nanoribbon.

Example 30 may include the apparatus of any one of examples 27-28 and/or some other examples herein, wherein the nanowire includes Si, Ge, Sn, In, Ga, As, Al, InAs, SiGe, InGaAs, InP, or a metal oxide.

Example 31 may include the apparatus of any one of examples 27-28 and/or some other examples herein, wherein the first etch stop layer or the second etch stop layer is doped with boron (B) or phosphorus (P).

Example 32 may include the apparatus of any one of examples 27-28 and/or some other examples herein, wherein the first etch stop layer or the second etch stop layer includes boron doped Si, boron doped Ge, boron doped SiGe, phosphorus doped Si, phosphorus doped Ge, or phosphorus doped SiGe.

Example 33 may include the apparatus of any one of examples 27-28 and/or some other examples herein, wherein the source electrode, the drain electrode, or the gate electrode includes a metallic material, a conductive polymer, a polysilicon, a titanium silicide, a phosphorus (n+) doped Si, a boron doped SiGe, or an alloy of a semiconductor material and a metal.

Example 34 may include the apparatus of any one of examples 27-28 and/or some other examples herein, wherein the substrate includes silicon, sapphire, glass, polyimide, SiC, GaN, or AlN.

Various embodiments may include any suitable combination of the above-described embodiments including alternative (or) embodiments of embodiments that are described in conjunctive form (and) above (e.g., the “and” may be “and/or”). Furthermore, some embodiments may include one or more articles of manufacture (e.g., non-transitory computer-readable media) having instructions, stored thereon, that when executed result in actions of any of the above-described embodiments. Moreover, some embodiments may include apparatuses or systems having any suitable means for carrying out the various operations of the above-described embodiments.

The above description of illustrated implementations, including what is described in the Abstract, is not intended to be exhaustive or to limit the embodiments of the present disclosure to the precise forms disclosed. While specific implementations and examples are described herein for illustrative purposes, various equivalent modifications are possible within the scope of the present disclosure, as those skilled in the relevant art will recognize.

15

These modifications may be made to embodiments of the present disclosure in light of the above detailed description. The terms used in the following claims should not be construed to limit various embodiments of the present disclosure to the specific implementations disclosed in the specification and the claims. Rather, the scope is to be determined entirely by the following claims, which are to be construed in accordance with established doctrines of claim interpretation.

What is claimed is:

1. A semiconductor device, comprising:
  - a substrate;
  - a channel region including a nanowire above the substrate;
  - a metallic source electrode and a metallic drain electrode above the substrate, wherein the metallic source electrode is laterally separated from a first end of the nanowire by a first semiconductor layer between the metallic source electrode and the nanowire, the first semiconductor layer having an uppermost surface co-planar with an uppermost surface of the metallic source electrode, and the metallic drain electrode is laterally separated from a second end of the nanowire by a second semiconductor layer between the metallic drain electrode and the nanowire, the second semiconductor layer having an uppermost surface co-planar with an uppermost surface of the metallic drain electrode;
  - a gate electrode over and around the nanowire, the gate electrode having a lateral width between the metallic source electrode and the metallic drain electrode that is greater than a lateral width of the nanowire between the metallic source electrode and the metallic drain electrode;
  - a first spacer above the substrate between the gate electrode and the metallic source electrode, a second spacer above the substrate between the gate electrode and the metallic drain electrode; and
  - a gate dielectric layer between the channel region and the gate electrode.
2. The semiconductor device of claim 1, wherein the nanowire is a first nanowire, and the channel region further includes a second nanowire, the metallic source electrode is laterally separated from a first end of the second nanowire by the first semiconductor layer between the metallic source electrode and the second nanowire, and the metallic drain electrode is laterally separated from a second end of the second nanowire by the second semiconductor layer between the metallic drain electrode and the second nanowire.
3. The semiconductor device of claim 1, wherein the first semiconductor layer is around sidewalls of the metallic source electrode, between the metallic source electrode and the substrate, and the second semiconductor layer is around sidewalls of the metallic drain electrode, between the metallic drain electrode and the substrate.
4. The semiconductor device of claim 1, wherein the nanowire transistor is a n-type transistor or a p-type transistor.
5. The semiconductor device of claim 1, wherein the nanowire is a rectangular nanowire, a circular nanowire, or a nanoribbon.
6. The semiconductor device of claim 1, wherein the first semiconductor layer has a thickness between the metallic source electrode and the nanowire less than 25 nm.
7. The semiconductor device of claim 1, wherein the nanowire includes Si, Ge, Sn, In, Ga, As, Al, InAs, SiGe, InGaAs, InP, or a metal oxide.

16

8. The semiconductor device of claim 1, wherein the first semiconductor layer or the second semiconductor layer is doped with boron (B) or phosphorus (P).

9. The semiconductor device of claim 1, wherein the first semiconductor layer or the second semiconductor layer includes boron doped Si, boron doped Ge, boron doped SiGe, phosphorus doped Si, phosphorus doped Ge, or phosphorus doped SiGe.

10. The semiconductor device of claim 1, wherein the gate electrode includes a metallic material, a conductive polymer, a phosphorus (n+) doped Si, a polysilicon, a titanium silicide, a boron doped SiGe, or an alloy of a semiconductor material and a metal.

11. The semiconductor device of claim 1, wherein the substrate includes silicon, sapphire, glass, polyimide, SiC, GaN, or AlN.

12. A computing device, comprising:

- a processor; and
- a memory device laterally separated from the processor, wherein the memory device or the processor includes a nanowire transistor comprising:
  - a substrate;
  - a channel region including a nanowire above the substrate;
  - a metallic source electrode and a metallic drain electrode above the substrate, wherein the metallic source electrode is laterally separated from a first end of the nanowire by a first semiconductor layer between the metallic source electrode and the nanowire, the first semiconductor layer having an uppermost surface co-planar with an uppermost surface of the metallic source electrode, and the metallic drain electrode is laterally separated from a second end of the nanowire by a second semiconductor layer between the metallic drain electrode and the nanowire, the second semiconductor layer having an uppermost surface co-planar with an uppermost surface of the metallic drain electrode;
  - a gate electrode over and around the nanowire, the gate electrode having a lateral width between the metallic source electrode and the metallic drain electrode that is greater than a lateral width of the nanowire between the metallic source electrode and the metallic drain electrode;
  - a first spacer above the substrate between the gate electrode and the metallic source electrode, a second spacer above the substrate between the gate electrode and the metallic drain electrode; and
  - a gate dielectric layer between the channel region and the gate electrode.

13. The computing device of claim 12, wherein the nanowire is a first nanowire, and the channel region further includes a second nanowire, the metallic source electrode is laterally separated from a first end of the second nanowire by the first semiconductor layer between the metallic source electrode and the second nanowire, and the metallic drain electrode is laterally separated from a second end of the second nanowire by the second semiconductor layer between the metallic drain electrode and the second nanowire.

14. The computing device of claim 12, wherein the first semiconductor layer is around sidewalls of the metallic source electrode, between the metallic source electrode and the substrate, and the second semiconductor layer is around sidewalls of the metallic drain electrode, between the metallic drain electrode and the substrate.

17

15. The computing device of claim 12, wherein the nanowire is a rectangular nanowire, a circular nanowire, or a nanoribbon.

16. The computing device of claim 12, wherein the computing device is a wearable device or a mobile computing device, the wearable device or the mobile computing device including one or more of an antenna, a touchscreen controller, a battery, an audio codec, a video codec, a power amplifier, a global positioning system (GPS) device, a compass, a Geiger counter, an accelerometer, a gyroscope, a speaker, or a camera coupled with the processor.

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18